BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT

Customer Support Portal

1. Executive Summary

The Customer Support Portal project aims to deliver an online self-service platform enabling customers to manage their support requests and track ticket statuses independently. This initiative is designed to significantly reduce the volume of incoming customer support calls while simultaneously enhancing the overall customer experience through improved transparency and accessibility. Key functionalities include customer registration, secure login, password management, ticket creation and tracking with email notifications, file uploads, and a dedicated dashboard for support agents to efficiently manage tickets and view reporting metrics.

2. Project Overview

Project Name: Customer Support Portal

Description: An online portal allowing customers to handle simple status updates and ticket requests themselves to reduce the volume of customer support calls.

3. Business Objectives

- Reduce support workload while improving customer experience by allowing customers to track their own requests online instead of calling.

4. Scope

In Scope

- Customer registration and secure login functionality.
- Customer ability to reset forgotten passwords.
- Customer capability to create, track, and search support tickets.
- Email notifications for customers on ticket status changes.
- Customer ability to upload attachments (screenshots, PDF documents) to tickets.
- Basic ticket editing for customers when a ticket is in 'Open' status.
- Dedicated dashboard for support agents to view, update, assign, and reassign tickets.
- Support agent ability to add internal, customer-hidden notes to tickets.
- Support agent/supervisor ability to search tickets by various criteria (ticket number, customer email, priority, assigned agent).
- System reporting on key metrics: number of open tickets, average resolution time, and tickets by priority.
- Secure storage and encryption of customer information.
- Multi-factor authentication for support agents and administrators.

Out of Scope

- Chatbot functionality.
- Live chat support.

- Social login integration.
- SMS notifications.
- Mobile application development (planned for Phase two).
- Multi-factor authentication for customers (for the initial release).

5. Stakeholders

- Sarah J johnson -- Business Product Manager (acme.com)
- Rahul Mehta (acme.com)
- Anita Sharma -- Security Architect (acme.com)

6. Business Requirements

- The system must provide customers with a self-service platform for support inquiries.
- The system must contribute to a reduction in inbound customer support call volume.
- The system must enhance customer experience by providing transparent ticket tracking and communication.
- The system must equip support agents with efficient tools for managing and resolving customer tickets.
- The system must ensure the security and privacy of all customer data and interactions.

7. Functional Requirements

- Customers should be able to register using their email address.
- Registered customers should be able to securely log in.
- Customers should be able to reset forgotten passwords via email.
- Customers should be able to create and track support tickets.
- Customers should receive email notifications whenever the status of a ticket changes.
- Support agents should have a dedicated dashboard to view all assigned tickets, update ticket status, and assign or reassign tickets to other agents.
- Support agents should be able to add internal notes that remain hidden from customers.
- Customers should be able to upload screenshots or PDF documents when submitting a ticket.
- Customers should be able to search for previously submitted tickets using the ticket number.
- Customers should be able to edit tickets only before the ticket moves to In Progress (while still Open).
- Support agents/supervisors should be able to search tickets by ticket number, customer email, priority, and assigned agent.
- The system should provide basic reporting on the number of open tickets, average resolution time, and tickets by priority.

8. Non-Functional Requirements

- Customer passwords must never be stored in plain text and should be securely hashed.
- All customer information should be encrypted while stored in the database.
- Support agents and administrators should authenticate using multi-factor authentication.
- User sessions should automatically expire after 15 minutes of inactivity.
- Only support agents and administrators should be able to access internal ticket notes.
- All important user actions should be recorded in audit logs for compliance purposes.
- Average response time should stay below five hundred milliseconds.
- Estimated around five thousand concurrent users.
- Ninety-nine point nine percent availability target.
- Daily database backups.

9. Assumptions & Constraints

Assumptions

Constraints

10. Risks & Decisions

Risks

Decisions

- Customer accounts will use email and password for the first release; MFA for customers can wait.
- Social login is marked as a future enhancement and not included in MVP.

11. Open Questions

- Should customers be allowed to reopen closed tickets?
- What is the max attachment size?
- Who owns archived tickets?
- Should managers export reports?